NBF-TBT-005 - Working at Height, Housekeeping, PPE, Smoking and Edge Protection

Delivered by Jack Aylward · 15/10/2026

Introduction

Today's talk covers working at height, including the use of straight ladders, together with housekeeping, personal protective equipment (PPE), the prohibition on smoking on site, and edge protection. Falls from height remain the leading cause of fatal and serious injury on construction sites. The topics are linked: poor housekeeping causes trips, a trip near an unprotected edge becomes a fall, and correct PPE and edge protection limit the consequences when something goes wrong.

Working at height

- Work at height only where the RAMS and permits cover the task, and where you have been briefed on the method.
- Use the safest means of access available. Where a podium, tower or mobile elevating work platform (MEWP) is suitable, use it in preference to a ladder.
- Do not climb the formwork, props, reinforcement or stacked material. Use designated access only.
- Secure all tools and materials against falling, and keep the area below clear or barriered off.
- Stop work at height in high wind, heavy rain or icy conditions, and report it to your supervisor.

Straight ladders

- A straight ladder is for access and for short-duration, light work only. It must not be used for work requiring both hands, heavy tools or heavy materials.
- Check the inspection tag and the condition of the stiles, rungs and feet before every use. Do not use a damaged, untagged or out-of-date ladder.
- Set the ladder on firm, level ground at an angle of 1 in 4 (1 m out for every 4 m of height). Do not place it on bricks, pallets or loose material.
- The ladder must extend at least 1 m above the landing point, and must be tied or otherwise secured at the top. Where it cannot be tied, a second person must foot it.
- Maintain three points of contact at all times, face the ladder, and keep your belt buckle between the stiles. Do not overreach.
- Do not carry loads that prevent a secure grip. Use a rope, hoist or second operative.
- Only one person on a ladder at a time. Do not use a ladder near doors, plant or crane lifts unless the area is barriered or guarded.

Edge protection

- Edge protection must be in place before any operative works near an unprotected edge, opening or stair void.
- A guardrail system consists of a top rail at least 950 mm above the working surface, an intermediate rail so that no gap exceeds 470 mm, and a toe board of at least 150 mm.
- Never remove, alter or bypass edge protection or an opening cover without authorisation. If it must be removed temporarily, it must be replaced immediately on completion of the task.
- Openings and holes must be covered with a secured, load-rated and clearly marked cover.
- If edge protection is missing, damaged or inadequate, stop work, keep clear of the edge and report it immediately.

Housekeeping

- Keep access routes, stairs, platforms and working areas clear at all times.
- Remove or bend over nails and screws in stripped timber. Never leave them protruding.
- Stack and store materials neatly and securely, away from edges and openings.
- Segregate waste into the correct skips as it is generated, not at the end of the shift.
- Keep cables and hoses off walkways, and clear offcuts, packaging and banding as you work.

Personal protective equipment (PPE)

- The following PPE is mandatory at all times on site: hard hat, hi-vis clothing, safety footwear, Level 3 cut-resistant gloves and safety glasses.
- Use task-specific PPE where required, including hearing protection, an FFP3 dust mask, a face shield and a harness with lanyard for fall arrest.

- Inspect your PPE at the start of every shift. Replace anything damaged, worn or out of date immediately.
- Do not modify hard hats, and do not share dust masks or hearing protection.

Smoking on site

- Smoking, including the use of e-cigarettes and vaping, is not permitted anywhere on this site.
- This applies to buildings, decks, stairs, plant, vehicles on site and all work areas.
- Formwork, timber, release agents, fuel and packaging are combustible. A discarded cigarette can start a fire, and a fire on a deck can block the means of escape.
- If you see smoking on site, report it to your supervisor.

Common causes of accidents

- Using a ladder for work that needs both hands, or for too long in one position.
- Overreaching rather than moving the ladder or platform.
- Removing edge protection or a hole cover and not replacing it.
- Leaving offcuts, banding and nailed timber where others will walk.
- PPE left off for a short task.

Questions and discussion

- Is edge protection complete and secure in every area where we are working this week?
- Are all ladders on site tagged, in date and secured?
- Is anyone's PPE worn, damaged or out of date?
- Where is housekeeping weakest on site, and what can be done about it?

Conclusion

Working at height safely depends on the right access, complete edge protection, a tidy work area and correct PPE, with no smoking anywhere on site. If anything is unsafe, stop, make it safe where you can do so without risk, and report it. If in doubt, ask your supervisor.

NEW BRIDGE
FORM
Patrician Secondary School, Newbridge

Toolbox Talk
NBF-TBT-005

Reference	NBF-TBT-005	**Date**	15/10/2026
Topic	Working at Height, Housekeeping, PPE, Smoking and Edge Protection	**Delivered by**	Razvan

By signing below I confirm I attended this toolbox talk, that I understood it, and that I had the chance to ask questions before signing.

Print Name	Signature	Date	Print Name	Signature	Date
Sean Coady			Radu Pop	Radu Pop	15/10
Jack Aylward		15/10	Bogdan Petru Steti		
Victor Gudumac		15/10	Cornel Ionut Calin		
Martin Coady			Ion Gusatu		
Alan McKenna		15/10	Eusebiu Balasca		
Ion George Motoc	Ion G M		Iulian Balasca		
Florea Calin			Giorgi Kharbedia		
Serghei Balas			Tornike Katcharava		
Ionut Laza			Sorin Merchidan		
Vitalie Nicoara		15/10	Marian Niculae		
Constantin Roman			Petrus Marius Radu	Petrus Radu	
Damien Galvin			Peti Sandu		
Mihai Roman			Calvin Aitken		
Doru-Ciprian Zamfir			David Aitken		
Constantin Ionut		17/10	Botezatu Ciprian Cătălin		
Stephen Kehoe			Alex Botezatu		
Paul McCaffrey	Paul M		Alexandru Vranceanu		
Marian Petre			Vasile Birladianu		
Marian Motoc			Razvan Claudiu Schiopu		
Constantin Robert			Vexhi Cekici		
Alin Tanase			Dritan Permargjeta		
Cosmin Alexandru Popei	Cosm		Ersi Celma		
Ioan Batin					

Tool Box Talk Register

TALK TOPIC:	Smoking On Site.
TOOL BOX TALK GIVEN BY:	[redacted]
SITE:	R115 Patrician Secondary School Newbridge
Any Other Topics Covered During Toolbox Talk:	There is no smoking permitted anywhere on Site. The designated smoking area/shelter at the welfare area is the only area for smoking on the site.
1.	
2.	
3.	

NAME: (PRINT)	SIGNATURE OF ATTENDEE:	EMPLOYER:
Victo- Gradona		MBF
Alan M[illegible]		mBF
ion [illegible]	Ian M[illegible]	
Serghei Bulig		mBF
Vitalie Nun		mbr
Mihi Roman		MBF
Gost Veut		
Paul McAffrey	Paul McAffrey	
maria Petre		
MariaMotoc		
Robert		
Cosmin		
Ion Betin		

Signed by Instructor:	[redacted]	Date:	15/10/'26